

eBay Inc. (EBAY): Unsolicited Proposal from GameStop; Board Acknowledges Receipt & Pending Review

On Sunday, May 3rd, GameStop Corp. (GME) announced the submission of a proposal to acquire eBay ([link](#)). The potential transaction would value eBay at \$125/sh and represent a ~20% premium to eBay's closing price on Friday, May 1st. At this valuation, EBAY shares would be valued at 17x our current FY27 Adj EBIT estimate and at 23x our current FY27 GAAP P/E estimate. In addition, we would note that GameStop has built a 5% economic stake in eBay through a combination of derivatives & common stock.

Per the press release, the potential transaction would be financed through 50% cash and 50% GameStop common stock. The cash consideration is expected to be funded by a combination of existing cash on the balance sheet (\$9.4bn as of Jan 31, 2026), and 3P acquisition financing (of which GME has received a highly confident letter from TD Securities for up to \$20bn). We would note that the GameStop equity value is currently ~\$12bn, which compares to eBay's current equity value of ~\$46bn.

Within Gamestop's offer proposal, the strategic rationale surrounding the deal was framed around:

- **Reducing costs.** Across EBAY's sales & marketing, product development, and G&A spend, GameStop outlined a target reduction of ~\$2bn in operating expenses (within the first 12 months of the closure of the proposed acquisition). On the back of these cost cuts, GameStop framed a pro-forma diluted GAAP EPS target of \$7.79, which compares to our FY26 / FY27 estimates of \$4.48 / \$5.36.
- **Synergies with US retail locations.** Within the shareholder presentation, GameStop framed there to be an opportunity to create an authentication, fulfillment and live commerce network - with EBAY's focus categories (which includes trading cards, collectibles & refurbished tech) aligning with GameStop's operations - given that staff already inspect & grade hardware and trading cards, the stores would also provide a physical footprint for eBay to compete within the live commerce category (and serve as a dropoff/shipping hub).
- **Leadership & alignment.** The proposed transaction also highlighted that following the closure, Ryan Cohen would serve as CEO of the combined entity.

We make no determination around the likelihood of such a transaction coming to fruition and make no changes to our operating estimates at this time.

Away from the reports of a transaction, we still expect the medium-to-long term

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fundamentals of EBAY to be centered on driving sustained GMV growth across key categories and geographies, while balancing operating margins and shareholder returns. Over the long-term on an operating performance basis, we see the key messages and operating guidance from the company’s Q1’26 earnings as the primary guiding factor.

We are Not Rated on EBAY.

EBAY	Price Target: --	Price: \$104.07	Upside: --
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NR	GS Forecast					
		12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E	
	Market cap: \$47.6bn	Revenue (\$ mn)	11,100.0	12,117.7	12,801.4	13,524.8
	Enterprise value: \$50.3bn	EBITDA (\$ mn)	3,272.0	3,576.4	4,014.3	4,325.6
	3m ADTV: \$532.1mn	EBIT (\$ mn)	2,258.0	2,571.3	2,936.3	3,183.0
	United States	EPS (\$)	5.48	6.11	6.89	7.59
	Americas Internet	P/E (X)	14.3	17.0	15.1	13.7
		EV/EBITDA (X)	12.5	13.6	11.2	9.7
		FCF yield (%)	4.0	5.8	7.1	7.7
		Dividend yield (%)	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
		Net debt/EBITDA (X)	1.5	0.8	(0.0)	(0.8)
		3/26	6/26E	9/26E	12/26E	
		EPS (\$)	1.66	1.49	1.45	1.50

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 1 May 2026 close.

Disclosure Appendix

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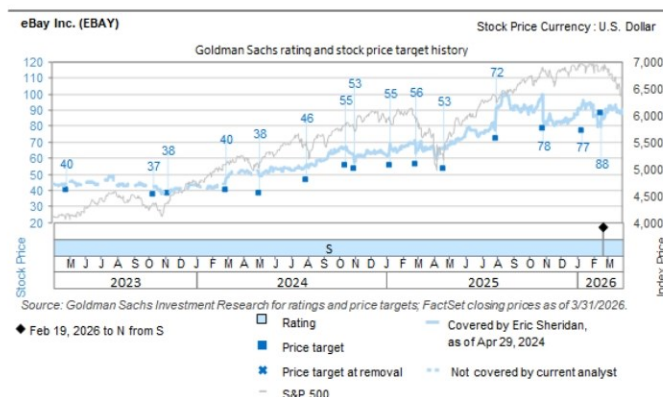
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eBay Inc. (EBAY)

Date of report	Target price (\$)	Closing price (\$)
30-Apr-26	100.00	103.48
19-Feb-26	88.00	84.75
13-Jan-26	77.00	94.37
30-Oct-25	78.00	83.73
31-Jul-25	72.00	91.75
21-Apr-25	53.00	65.63
27-Feb-25	56.00	63.48
08-Jan-25	55.00	69.40
31-Oct-24	53.00	57.51
15-Oct-24	55.00	66.99
01-Aug-24	46.00	56.23
02-May-24	38.00	49.39
28-Feb-24	40.00	47.89
08-Nov-23	38.00	39.95
12-Oct-23	37.00	42.63

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